

Thursday, 6 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

22° 15°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

18° 12°

MANCHESTER

Drizzle

18° 12°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

18° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 A man has been charged with murder after the tragic death of a nine-year-old girl in Scotland.**
Minnie Merriman was found injured in Arbroath on Monday, and a 35-year-old man appeared in court yesterday. Her family have said they are completely 'devastated' by the news.
CRIME · UK
- 2 A woman has been arrested after four men were stabbed in central London yesterday.**
The Metropolitan Police confirmed the arrests, with details still emerging about the circumstances. Emergency services were called to the scene in the afternoon.
CRIME · UK
- 3 No misconduct case will be brought against the police officer who shot Chris Kaba in London.**
The head of the Met Police, Sir Mark Rowley, has welcomed the decision by the Independent Office for Police Conduct. However, he also described the accountability process as 'disgraceful'.
POLICING · UK
- 4 A police chief is considering legal action over the early release of two of PC Andrew Harper's killers.**
The government's early release scheme begins in October, and the two men are set to be included. PC Harper was killed in the line of duty in 2019.
JUSTICE · UK
- 5 Farmers are warning that vegetables will become smaller and more expensive this year due to the hot weather.**
They say this year's harvest could be the worst on record because of the exceptionally dry spring and summer. It means we could see an impact on our supermarket shelves.
ENVIRONMENT · UK

What's coming up

1 **The popular dog trainer Graeme Hall is joining the star-studded line-up for the new series of Strictly Come Dancing!**

Known as 'The Dogfather' from Channel 5's 'Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly', Graeme will be swapping dog leads for dance shoes. It'll be fascinating to see how he takes to the ballroom!

ON AIR – What kind of dance do you think Graeme Hall will be best at? Maybe something with a bit of a 'heel-toe' action?

TV · AUTUMN

2 **Big news for TikTok creators, as Disney has agreed a deal to let them use clips from its films and TV shows!**

This means we could see a lot more Disney magic appearing in short-form videos across the platform. It's a huge move that could spark even more creativity.

ON AIR – Which Disney film or TV show do you think will be the most popular for TikTokers to use?

SOCIAL MEDIA · ONGOING

3 **The brilliant Irish singer-songwriter Kate Nash is set to cover a Sinéad O'Connor classic at an upcoming festival!**

She'll be performing at The Mac as part of the fringe programme for the Fleadh Cheoil na hÉireann. Kate will also be exploring her own Irish history and heritage.

ON AIR – Which Sinéad O'Connor song do you think Kate Nash should cover?

MUSIC · AUGUST

4 **A Northern Irish author has shared the incredible story of how she did her first book signing in a police custody suite!**

She's now sold over five million books globally, translated into 40 languages. What an unusual start to a hugely successful career!

ON AIR – What's the most unusual place you've ever had to sign something important?

BOOKS · ONGOING

5 **Ever wondered what your summer reading list says about you? Apparently, our holiday book choices can reveal a lot!**

Studies suggest that the books we pick subconsciously reflect parts of our personality. So, what's on your poolside pile this year?

ON AIR – What's on your summer reading list, and what do you think it says about you?

BOOKS · SUMMER

On the schedule

1

Arsenal are set to make a big move, signing Newcastle captain Bruno Guimaraes!

BBC Sport has been looking at why the Gunners are so keen to bring the midfielder to the Emirates. It's a transfer that could really shake up the Premier League.

ON AIR – Arsenal fans, how do you feel about signing Guimaraes? And Newcastle supporters, will you miss him?
FOOTBALL · UK

2

Jemima Lines has made history, becoming the first British woman in 90 years to be selected for the America's Cup team!

She's hailed it as a 'pivotal moment' for the sport of sailing. It's fantastic to see such a significant achievement in British sport.

ON AIR – What an incredible achievement for Jemima Lines! Do you think this will inspire more women to get into competitive sailing?
SAILING · UK

3

Rugby League fans, get ready! Warrington Wolves and Wigan Warriors are set to clash in Dublin in 2027.

It will be the first Super League fixture ever played in Ireland, promising an exciting event for fans. Mark your calendars for this historic match!

ON AIR – Are you excited about the Super League heading to Dublin? Which other cities would you like to see host a major rugby league game?
RUGBY LEAGUE · UK

4

Runs and records were broken galore last night as Sunrisers Leeds posted the biggest score in Hundred history!

They made an incredible 241 runs on a night when numerous records tumbled, beating London Spirit by 37 runs. It was an absolutely sensational batting display!

ON AIR – Did you watch the Sunrisers' record-breaking innings? What was your favourite moment from that incredible game?
CRICKET · UK

5

Hull City have made a club-record signing, bringing in Greek goalkeeper Konstantinos Tzolakis from Olympiacos.

He's signed a five-year deal, marking a significant investment for the Championship club. Fans will be hoping he can make a big impact.

ON AIR – Hull City fans, how do you feel about your new record signing? Do you think he'll be a game-changer for the team?
FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The joy of rediscovering classic board games is bringing families closer, a new study suggests.**
Researchers found that switching off screens for a game of Monopoly or Scrabble significantly boosts interaction and laughter amongst different generations.
- 2 A surprising new trend highlights the simple pleasure of 'window gardening' in urban flats.**
Even without a garden, people are finding creative ways to grow herbs and small plants on their windowsills, bringing a touch of nature indoors.
- 3 Experts are touting the benefits of 'themed walks' for mental well-being.**
Instead of just walking, participants focus on spotting specific colours, shapes, or types of plants, turning a simple stroll into a mindful adventure.
- 4 The unexpected appeal of 'repurposing everyday objects' is capturing imaginations nationwide.**
From turning old ladders into bookshelves to using vintage teacups as plant pots, people are embracing creative upcycling.
- 5 A recent report celebrates the comforting ritual of 'reading physical newspapers' with a cup of tea.**
Despite the digital age, many find a unique pleasure in the tactile experience of turning pages and savouring local news stories.
- 6 There's a growing movement towards 'exploring local markets' for unique finds and community spirit.**
People are discovering the charm of independent stalls, handmade crafts, and locally sourced produce, all while connecting with their neighbours.
- 7 The simple act of 'writing and posting postcards' is experiencing a delightful comeback.**
Sending a handwritten note from your holiday destination is seen as a more personal and memorable gesture than a quick digital message.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to put together flat-pack furniture, even though we know it's probably a bad idea?

ANSWER: IGNORING THE INSTRUCTIONS AND JUST 'WINGING IT' UNTIL WE GET STUCK!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, hot bubble bath. What is it?

ANSWER: CHECKING THE WATER TEMPERATURE WITH THEIR TOE AT LEAST THREE TIMES, JUST TO BE SURE!

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those 'little domestic inventions' we've come up with to solve an everyday problem around the house, don't we?**

What's a quirky, homemade solution or 'hack' you've devised that you're surprisingly proud of? Perhaps it's a unique way to organise your remote controls, or a clever trick for reaching that high shelf!

- **Think about a 'small, everyday sound' that you absolutely adore, one that just makes you feel incredibly content or happy.**

Is it the gentle purr of your kettle, the satisfying 'thunk' of a letterbox, or perhaps the rustle of leaves outside your window? Give us a call and tell us your favourite comforting sound!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a parliament.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Baby puffins are called 'pufflings'.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£94 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£94 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's first public park was Birkenhead Park in Merseyside, inspiring New York's Central Park.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest, if conditions are right, due to their unique wing design.
- The smallest independent state in the world is Vatican City.
- It is illegal to sing 'Happy Birthday' in public for commercial purposes in the UK, due to copyright laws.
- Strawberries are the only fruit with seeds on the outside.
- The 'unicorn' is the national animal of Scotland.
- Hot water freezes faster than cold water, a phenomenon known as the Mpemba effect.
- The first British monarch to live in Buckingham Palace was Queen Victoria.

On this day

Day 218 of the year, 147 days left in 2026. Today Christian holidays and observances Transfiguration of Jesus; Christian holidays and observances Anna Maria Rubatto; Christian holidays and observances Pope Hormisdas; Christian holidays and observances Justus and Pastor. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1928 — Andy Warhol, American painter, photographer and film director (died 1987)
- 1969 — Elliott Smith, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2003)
- 1981 — Leslie Odom Jr., American actor and singer
- 1940 — Louise Sorel, American actress
- 1932 — Michael Deeley, English screenwriter and producer
- 1987 — Leanne Crichton, Scottish footballer
- 1951 — Catherine Hicks, American actress
- 1930 — Abbey Lincoln, American singer-songwriter and actress (died 2010)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1914 — World War I: U-boat campaign: Two days after the United Kingdom had declared war on Germany over the German invasion of Belgium, ten German U-boats leave their base in Heligoland to attack Royal Navy warships in the North Sea.
- 2008 — A military junta led by Mohamed Ould Abdel Aziz stages a coup d'état in Mauritania, overthrowing president Sidi Ould Cheikh Abdallahi.
- 1997 — Korean Air Flight 801 crashed at Nimitz Hill, Guam, killing 229 of the 254 people on board.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1965 — US President Lyndon B. Johnson signs the Voting Rights Act of 1965 into law.
- 1958 — Law of Permanent Defense of Democracy, outlawing the Communist Party of Chile and banning 26,650 persons from the electoral lists, is repealed in Chile.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1926 — Gertrude Ederle becomes the first woman to swim across the English Channel.
- 1915 — World War I: Battle of Sari Bair: The Allies mount a diversionary attack timed to coincide with a major Allied landing of reinforcements at Suvla Bay.

- 1960 — Cuban Revolution: Cuba nationalizes American and foreign-owned property in the nation.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 219 of the year, 146 days left in 2026. Today Assyrian Martyrs Day (Assyrian community); Battle of Boyacá Day (Colombia); Christian feast day: Afra; Christian feast day: Albert of Trapani. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1944 — John Glover, American actor
- 1974 — Chico Benymon, American actor
- 1969 — Paul Lambert, Scottish footballer and manager
- 1955 — Wayne Knight, American actor, comedian and voice actor
- 1961 — Brian Conley, English actor and singer
- 1975 — Charlize Theron, South African actress
- 1937 — Don Wilson, English cricketer and coach (died 2012)
- 1966 — Kristin Hersh, American singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2008 — The start of the Russo-Georgian War over the territory of South Ossetia.
- 1962 — Canadian-born American pharmacologist Frances Oldham Kelsey is awarded the U.S. President's Award for Distinguished Federal Civilian Service for her refusal to authorize thalidomide.
- 1995 — The Chilean government declares state of emergency in the southern half of the country in response to an event of intense, cold, wind, rain and snowfall known as the White Earthquake.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1960 — Ivory Coast becomes independent from France.
- 2020 — Air India Express Flight 1344 overshoots the runway at Calicut International Airport in the Malappuram district of Kerala, India, and crashes, killing 21 of the 190 people on board.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)